

MINUTES

For the meeting of the **Middleton Grange School Board** **Monday, 19 May 2025**



6.00 pm / SLT Meeting Room (Main Reception)

Welcome & Devotion

Present	Mel Hikuroa (Chair), Mike Vannoort, Rebekah Immanuel, Andy Milne, Chris Hannen, Nick Pomare, Sisilia Misa, Alexis O'Connell, David Gillon Via Teams: G Robson
In attendance	Cambodia Missions Trip delegates: - Christine Buckley (staff), Sara Buckley, Joel Thompson (students) Craig Utting (Associate Principal) Hillary Carley (Minute Secretary)
Prior Leave	Karen Winder
Apologies	Tony Kan
Devotion	Alexis O'Connell. John 19: 25-37 Jesus' last words were addressed to his mother. We are left with room to respond to the darkest moment in human history and its unimaginable suffering, that fulfilled scripture, with emotion or imagination and the knowledge that there is beauty in the chaos and that Jesus transforms confusion and grief as we trust in him. Alexis ka inoi / prayed

Special Topic

1. Cambodia Services & Missions Trip Group

- The trip was a valuable experience and contained many opportunities with partnered organisations including eg outreach, work in slum areas, kids programmes, pre-school, programmes connecting children with the gospel, work in both rural and urban areas etc that all help to show Christ's love to the children they engage with.
- Whilst having some background history of Cambodia was beneficial, witnessing poverty first hand was hard to prepare for and impacting for students, however, the reality also helped to change their perspectives 'outwards'. It was encouraging to see the strong faith of local Christians in Cambodia despite their circumstances.
- Viewing the Killing Fields was also significantly impactful for students.
- Students were given ample time to self-reflect, unpack, talk, share devotions, journal and pray using 'sad, mad, glad' strategies whilst in Cambodia in order to process their days. This has continued following their return to NZ and students have grown spiritually and become close as a group.
- The experience has provided students with future focus and how questions about how that may impact their chosen careers going forward eg less focused on money and success and more on service and fulfilment.
- Students from previous trips to Cambodia messaged the team with support and positive memories of their visits.

Andy Milne prayed after which Christine Buckley, Sara Buckley and Joel Thompson left the meeting at 6.58 pm.

Actions

Ongoing actions / items added by agreement

See Readings below

1. REPORTING

- a. Dean McKenzie, DP School Management, received no questions following the previous meeting with regards to his presentation on reporting at the previous meeting.

Administration

1. ADMINISTRATION

a. MINUTES

Motion:

That the Minutes of the meeting of 7 April 2025 be accepted as a true and accurate record of the meeting.

Moved Mel Hikuroa, Presiding Member

CARRIED

b. DEVOTIONS

Confirm for next meeting / 23 June 2025 - Rebekah Immanuel

c. BOARD

i. PROCESSES

- Student Reporting reviewed later in the meeting.
- There is a standing invitation for Board Members to attend staff prayer on Friday's at 8.00 am in the Staffroom.

ii. BOARD TRIENNIAL ELECTION

- Board Member photos will be taken at the same time as school photos.

Discussion

Where any actions are required See Readings

1. STRATEGIC PLAN 2024 - 2025

- a. **SG 1B** has been amended to cover roll growth, with a motion included below.

Action / Agreed

- Management to report back to the Board and Proprietor on by the end of 2025.
- Scope of works to be reported to the Board at the next meeting.

AIP ANALYSIS OF VARIANCE

For update see Principal's Strategic Report.

a. **SG 3A: Marketing / PR Communications**

The quote from Alexanders Digital Marketing has been received.

Action / Agreed

- Proposal from parent connection to be submitted to the next meeting.
- b. **SG 3B: Parent Induction**
- Challenges include attracting parents to attend additional meetings.
 - Communications must be relevant.
 - Consideration to be given to Special Character Donation (SCD) collection and practices at Christian Education Network (CEN) contributing schools where there are differing views around fee structure, and some schools that have lower fees due to different Proprietor and being part of the Government Donations scheme.

Action / Agreed

- Consider production of a brochure for CEN graduating students that includes the variance in fees from their current school.
- Commence a conversation with the CEN board to work towards a shared vision and understanding around Attendance Dues and SCD.
- Report back on parent induction in Term 3.

2. POLICIES

a. DELEGATIONS POLICY

Changes approved.

b. CONCERNS OR COMPLAINTS POLICY

Action / Agreed

- That a board working group if required, to reconvene in Term 3 2025 to review our current Concerns or Complaints Policy and practices, including documentation.

3. OUTSTANDING RECOMMENDATIONS

a. BOARD EMAIL ADDRESSES

A recommendation was received from the school internet provider that all Board Members use school email addresses, and has been investigated further.

Action / Agreed

- That Board Members use school generated email address for Board business following the September 2025 Triennial elections.

4. PRINCIPAL'S STRATEGIC REPORT

- **MOE** Mike Vannoort reported that there continues to be a significant number of Ministry of Education (MOE) changes for implementation over the next 3-5 years.
- **Attendance** Middleton Grange School has an attendance rate of 95% of students attending with 9-10 days absent per term - attaining the MOE target. Areas of work include: families taking students on family holidays during term time and older students being required to care for younger siblings at times.
- **Finance Committee Minutes / NZ Uniforms** The sponsorship funds credited to Middleton Grange School must be used for uniform, and would therefore be used in place of eg Hardship Fund monies in the first instance.

a. **ENROLMENTS / 2026 ENTRY**

A discussion was held to establish the best process for determining Preference enrolment applicants.

- Church practice must align with the school's Integration Agreement.
- Best practice is to interview all applicants, however, it is acknowledged that it is not possible to achieve this presently.

Action / Agreed

- Current enrolment season - interview New Entrant and Year 7, 9 and 11 applicants who have no prior connection with the school or CEN, or any applicants where there may be a concern around Special Character from CEN schools, with pre-agreed questions for group moderation.
- Interview questions to be written and then reviewed by the Proprietor.
- Management to identify and notify the Board of appropriate interview dates in mid-June for interviewing Middle and Senior College applicants. A date for interviewing New Entrant applicants will be made for Term 3.
- Consider approaching Church Leaders to be involved in the interview process.

5. **INTERNAL REVIEW**

Reviewed and updated

6. **STUDENT TRUSTEE REPORT**

The meeting reviewed the change where the Student Trustee has not provided a written report in line with the Staff Representative, and considered if it should be reinstated to best represent the student voice.

Action / Agreed

- That student voice, when gathered in an official capacity eg survey, be included in the Principal's Report for annual review.

Geoff Robson left the meeting at approximately 8.08 am.

Motions

See Readings for any relevant papers

a. **STRATEGIC PLAN 2024-2025**

Motion

To adjust the Strategic Plan 2024-2025 by removing that Strategic Goal *To implement a Graduate Profile framework* and replace it with the following:

- Strategic Goal 3B: *Investigate the manageability of Middleton Grange School to cater for its anticipated roll growth due to the Maximum Roll Increase (MRI) of Christian Education Network (CEN) schools.*
- Actions: *Gather data on the **overall capacity and current** utilization of classrooms and facilities at MGS. Gather data on the projected roll increases for the CEN schools for the next 5 years. Determine where the pressure points are re: classrooms / facilities / subjects / etc. Explore options to resolve these pressure points for the next 5 years in order to maximize the utilization of facilities. **Report to Board and CST re: MGS capacity and utilization, SWOT of current CEN model, options to cater for growth***

MOVED Mel, Hikuroa, Presiding Member

CARRIED

b. **COMMITTEES**

i. **Finance Committee**

To accept the following:

- a. Minutes of the Finance Committee of 12 May 2025 and any recommendations contained therein with the following amendment:
 - BLAST is ~~a Board~~ approved **by the Board to run its** programme which provides a valued and essential service to our school community **in the school.**
- b. 31 December 2024 audited accounts
- c. Annual Report 2024 with the inclusion of the audited accounts once finalised and approved.
- d. To write off \$3,480 outstanding rental fees for the BLAST After School & Holiday Programme.

MOVED Andy Milne
Seconder Chris Hannen
CARRIED

c. **POLICIES**

i. **DELEGATIONS POLICY**

To adopt the Delegations Policy with the amendments following amendments/addition:

- Delegations retained by the Board:
 6. Approval of overseas and high risk activities.
 12. Staff exit interviews. Procedures outlined in the Board Handbook.
- Board Delegations to the Principal
 - 1.4 The Principal may approve EOTC trips within New Zealand other than high risk activities.
- Health & Safety Committee Membership
 - MGS Board (2 minimum with 1 Board rep from Property Committee)
 - Property Manager
 - Staff Board Member
- IBOA Committee Meeting Schedule
 - Meet once per term unless the need arises for an additional meeting.
 - ~~Plan for two each term with the minimum of once per term.~~

MOVED Mel Hikuroa
CARRIED

ii. **CONCERNS OR COMPLAINTS POLICY**

Deferred

NOT MOVED

d. **PRINCIPAL'S STRATEGIC REPORT**

i. **PRINCIPAL'S STRATEGIC REPORT**

That the Principal's Strategic Report be accepted

MOVED Mike Vannoort
Seconder Nick Pomare
CARRIED

e. **CEN HEADS OF AGREEMENT**

To ratify the Heads of Agreement re Enrolment Scheme 2025, including Appendices.

MOVED Mel Hikuroa
CARRIED

Correspondence

See Correspondence section

1. None

Student Board Member

Verbal update

Move to Public Excluded / In Committee

Motion

‘That the public be excluded from the following part/s of the proceedings of this meeting.
The general subject of each matter to be considered while the public is excluded, the reason for passing this resolution in relation to each matter, and the specific grounds under [section 48\(1\)](#) of the Local Government Official Information and Meetings Act 1987 for the passing of is resolution are as follows:

General subject of each matter to be considered	Reason for passing this resolution in relation to each matter	Ground(s) under section 48(1) for the passing of this resolution
Disciplinary matters	Protect the privacy of individuals	S48(1)(a)(ii)

This resolution is made in reliance on [section 48\(1\)\(a\)](#) of the Local Government Official Information and Meetings Act 1987 and the particular interest or interests protected by [section 7](#) of that Act which would be prejudiced by the holding of the whole or the relevant part of the proceedings of the meeting in public.’

Moved Mel Hikuroa, Presiding Member

CARRIED

Motion ‘That the meeting move back into public session.’

CARRIED

Moved Chris Hannen, Deputy Presiding Member, Chair

The meeting closed in prayer at 8.50 pm.

Next Meeting

Date 23 June 2025
Devotion Rebekah Immanuel
Discussion Topic
Prior Leave

office@middleton.school.nz
www.middleton.school.nz

03 348 9826

30 Acacia Avenue, Upper Riccarton, Christchurch 8041